

creative marketing campaigns (And a little Mac-bashing) in an attempt to sway public opinion, none of which seemed to have an effect, except being a topic of discussion and mockery on tech forums.

You are probably wondering what type of improvements Windows 7 would offer over Vista or legacy Windows XP. Is Windows 7 just Vista with a facelift, or has Microsoft learned from its mistakes and delivered a product that Vista should have been from the start that will restore its battered reputation and stop its revenues from plummeting further south?

1.2.1 Performance

Windows 7 performs better than Vista and is also faster than XP, although XP, with its lightweight core remains more capable for devices with limited memory and outdated graphics. Vista is just outright sluggish. Windows 7 is better optimised for multi-core CPUs and includes a number of tweaks to make the best of the latest hardware. It delivers excellent results, beating or coming close to the performance of the lightweight XP in just about every category. Working on light applications comes at par with XP and working with processor and memory intensive applications is a breeze when compared to both Vista and XP.

1.2.2 Memory management and cache usage

With Vista, Microsoft introduced a new technology called SuperFetch for caching applications and speeding up boot times. This feature preloads frequently-used applications into RAM, so they can be accessed quicker when they're needed.

The SuperFetch feature in Windows 7 differs significantly in approach and cache memory usage from its counterpart in Vista. Under Vista, the caching of applications starts immediately at boot-up. In Windows 7, SuperFetch gets a delayed start and eventually also allocates much lesser RAM to it. This means Windows 7 uses lesser resources without affecting performance and launch time of applications. The cache usage is also lower as compared to Vista.

1.2.3 Networking

Windows Vista had promised optimised TCP/IP, but didn't live up to the hype. There were new features like option to set up ad hoc Wi-Fi networks using the Network Setup wizard, WPA2 encryption, remembering settings for different LAN connections and the Network Map displaying a graphical